

Reunion / Still Yours

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CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER

SCENE 8 — REUNION / “STILL YOURS”

CONTINUOUS FROM SCENE 7

Mary is still at Elizabeth’s home. She is calmer than when she arrived, but she is not healed.

She sits with a piece of cloth or another simple household task. Elizabeth is nearby.

Elizabeth notices someone approaching before Mary does.

Joseph appears. He carries the tool satchel Mary made for him.

ELIZABETH

Mary.

Mary looks up.

She sees Joseph.

For one instant, hope reaches her before she can stop it.

Elizabeth looks from Joseph to Mary. She understands that this conversation belongs to them.

ELIZABETH

I’ll be nearby.

Elizabeth exits without ceremony.

Mary and Joseph remain several feet apart.

Joseph does not rush toward her.

Silence.

THE REUNION

MARY

You came.

JOSEPH

Yes.

MARY

Why?

Joseph has rehearsed nothing useful.

JOSEPH

I was wrong.

Mary looks at him.

MARY

About which part?

Joseph takes the sting.

JOSEPH

About you.

Silence.

JOSEPH

You told me the truth.

Beat.

JOSEPH

And I didn't believe you.

He does not qualify it.

JOSEPH

I'm sorry.

Mary does not immediately soften.

MARY

What changed?

WHAT CHANGED

JOSEPH

I prayed.

Mary waits.

JOSEPH

And God answered.

Mary understands before she wants to.

MARY

A messenger?

JOSEPH

Yes.

MARY

What did he say?

Joseph looks directly at her.

JOSEPH

That you told me the truth.

Silence.

JOSEPH

I believe you.

Mary has needed those words. They still do not erase what happened.

MARY

I needed you to believe me before an angel told you to.

JOSEPH

I know.

MARY

I needed you.

Beat.

MARY

And you left.

JOSEPH

I know.

MARY

Do you?

Joseph does not answer too quickly.

MARY

When Gabriel left, I was afraid.

JOSEPH

Mary—

MARY

No.

She steadies herself.

MARY

I was afraid of my family. The village. What people would say when they looked at me.

Beat.

MARY

But I still had you.

That lands.

MARY

I thought whatever happened... I still had you.

Beat.

MARY

And then I told you.

She looks at him.

MARY

And I didn't.

Joseph has no defense.

JOSEPH

I'm sorry.

Beat.

JOSEPH

I don't know what that felt like.

He forces himself not to hide behind an explanation.

JOSEPH

But I know I caused it.

JOSEPH TELLS THE TRUTH

MARY

Why?

JOSEPH

I wanted to believe you.

MARY

But you didn't.

JOSEPH

No.

MARY

Why?

Joseph looks toward nothing, the life he had been so certain he could build.

JOSEPH

Because if I believed you... everything I thought I understood was gone.

MARY

Everything?

JOSEPH

The house.

Beat.

JOSEPH

The table. The life I thought we were building.

MARY

We were building it.

JOSEPH

I know.

Beat.

JOSEPH

And suddenly I couldn't see what came next.

MARY

Neither could I.

JOSEPH

You still said yes.

MARY

Yes.

Joseph absorbs that.

JOSEPH

I was afraid of what people would say. What it would do to you. To us.

Beat.

JOSEPH

But underneath all of that...

He finally names it.

JOSEPH

I was afraid because I couldn't fix it.

Mary sees him clearly.

MARY

You couldn't control it.

Joseph looks at her.

JOSEPH

No.

Beat.

JOSEPH

And I thought if I couldn't understand the road, there wasn't one.

Silence.

THE COST HAS NOT DISAPPEARED

MARY

People are still going to talk.

JOSEPH

I know.

MARY

They'll look at us.

JOSEPH

I know.

MARY

They may never believe us.

Joseph considers that honestly.

JOSEPH

They may not.

MARY

And you're still afraid.

JOSEPH

Yes.

Mary is surprised by the answer.

JOSEPH

The messenger told me not to be afraid.

Beat.

JOSEPH

He didn't tell me I would suddenly stop feeling it.

Mary recognizes her own journey in his.

MARY

No.

A small shared understanding.

MARY

He didn't.

WHAT JOSEPH CAN OFFER

JOSEPH

I don't know what this costs.

Beat.

JOSEPH

I don't know what our life looks like anymore.

MARY

Then what are you offering me?

Joseph thinks.

Then, simply—

JOSEPH

Me.

Mary looks at him.

JOSEPH

I don't have a plan anymore.

Beat.

JOSEPH

But I'm not leaving you to pay for this alone.

Mary lets the words reach her.

THE CHILD

JOSEPH

The messenger told me not to be afraid to take you as my wife.

Mary watches him.

JOSEPH

He told me the child comes from God.

Beat.

JOSEPH

And he told me that when the time comes... I will name him.

MARY

And what do you want?

Joseph looks at Mary.

JOSEPH

You.

Beat.

His attention shifts not possessively, but toward the life Mary now carries.

JOSEPH

This.

He cannot quite name the size of it.

JOSEPH

Whatever this becomes.

Beat.

JOSEPH

I want to stay.

Mary searches his face.

MARY

Because the messenger told you to?

JOSEPH

No.

Beat.

JOSEPH

Because I choose to.

That distinction matters.

THE OLD PROMISE

A little silence.

JOSEPH

I told you something once.

MARY

You told me many things.

JOSEPH

I said whatever came... I'd walk with you.

Mary remembers.

MARY

You did.

JOSEPH

I thought I knew what "whatever" meant.

A faint trace of their old warmth.

JOSEPH

A leaking roof.

MARY

You would have fixed it before it leaked.

JOSEPH

Exactly.

JOSEPH

A bigger table.

MARY

Eight chairs.

JOSEPH

Maybe.

MARY

Eight?

The smallest almost-smile.

JOSEPH

Children who wouldn't sleep.

Beat.

JOSEPH

Your garden dying because you refused to let me help.

MARY

My garden would have been fine.

JOSEPH

Of course.

For a breath, they are the young couple from Scene 2.

Then the truth returns.

JOSEPH

I thought I knew the road.

MARY

And now?

JOSEPH

Now I know I don't.

Beat.

JOSEPH

But if you'll let me...

He does not move closer.

JOSEPH

I'd still like to walk it with you.

MUSIC BEGINS

"STILL YOURS" / "MY BELOVED" REPRISE

Do not turn this into another full ballad.

It is a transformed fragment of "My Beloved."

Joseph's musical territory

*I promised you a road
I thought that I could see,
a house, a table, years ahead—
a life for you and me.*

Then the transformation

*The road I knew is gone,
the future isn't clear,
but I can choose to stand beside you
even while I'm scared.*

Mary answers from her own agency

*I said yes before I knew
what yes would ask of me.
I cannot promise where this road goes—
only that I'll walk willingly.*

The music returns to the familiar motif.

THE HAND

Joseph slowly extends his hand.

He does not reach for Mary.

He offers.

Mary looks at his hand.

Then at Joseph.

Joseph waits.

Do not hurry this silence. The reconciliation belongs to Mary too.

Finally—

MARY TAKES HIS HAND

The harmony opens. The physical choice is the climax.

JOSEPH

Whatever comes...

MARY

Whatever comes...

MARY & JOSEPH

We'll walk together.

Music resolves warmly, but not triumphantly.

AFTER THE REPRISE

They remain together for a breath.

MARY

So what happens now?

Joseph looks toward the road back to Nazareth.

JOSEPH

We go home.

Mary knows what "home" means now.

MARY

They're going to talk.

JOSEPH

Definitely.

Mary almost laughs.

Then—

MARY

Together?

Joseph looks at her.

JOSEPH

Together.

They begin walking side by side.

TRANSITION INTO SCENE 9

No haze. No ominous lighting cue.

The familiar Nazareth marketplace ambience from Scene 1 begins to return.

For a moment, it sounds exactly like home.

Then Mary and Joseph enter the edge of that world.

One conversation stops.

Someone looks.

Another person looks away.

Mary's hand tightens around Joseph's.

Joseph answers the pressure with his own.

Neither lets go.

They keep walking.

END SCENE 8